is led by a populist, one if one of the two states is led by a populist, and two if both are led by populists). As in other chapters, we utilize populism data from Funke, Schularick, and Trebesch (2023). Our dependent variable measures the number of information-sharing agreements signed between two IOs in a given year.

In some of our models, we include additional control variables, following Clark (2021). First, we control for the difference in the number of member states belonging to each IO—existing work suggests that IOs with relatively few resources prefer to cooperate with richer IOs. We also account for geopolitical ties between leading stakeholders across IOs by including a binary equal to one if such states are allies. Last, we control for geographic proximity between IOs.

We use negative binomial models with dyad and year-fixed effects. Standard errors are robust and clustered at the dyad level. Our parsimonious baseline model includes no additional control variables, and we subsequently add the control variables described previously.

Our analysis, the results for which are found in table 4.1, reveals a strong and statistically significant relationship between populist leadership in an IO's leading stakeholder and the frequency of information-sharing agreements. When one of the two IOs in a dyad is led by a populist stakeholder, the likelihood of signing such agreements increases by approximately 20 percent.[17] This suggests that IOs actively compensate for the informational gaps created by populist resistance by seeking alternative sources of data through collaboration with other IOs.

These findings hold across various robustness checks, including alternative model specifications, additional control variables, and different fixed-effects structures. For instance, we account for the geographic proximity of IO headquarters, differences in organizational size, and geopolitical alliances between leading stakeholders, all of which might influence the propensity for cooperation. In all cases, the results confirm our central contention: IOs respond to the challenges posed by populist leadership by forging stronger interorganizational connections.